THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — SOCIAL SCIENCE · PRACTICE QUESTION PAPER

Mid-Term / Half-Yearly Examination · Session 2026–27 · Set 04

Class: 8	Subject: Social Science	Set 04	Time Allowed: 2 Hours 30 Minutes	Max. Marks: 60

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper is divided into six sections – A, B, C, D, E and F.
3. Section A contains Question No. 1 with 15 sub-parts, all Multiple Choice Questions. Each sub-part carries 1 mark. Choose the correct option.
4. Section B contains Question Nos. 2 to 5, which are very short answer questions carrying 2 marks each. Answer each question in at least 20 words.
5. Section C contains Question Nos. 6 and 7, which are short answer questions carrying 3 marks each. Answer each question in about 40–60 words.
6. Section D contains Question Nos. 8 and 9, which are long answer questions carrying 5 marks each. Answer each question in about 80–100 words.
7. Section E contains Question Nos. 10 to 13, which are source/case-based questions carrying 4 marks each (1+1+2). Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow.
8. Section F contains Question No. 14, a map-based question carrying 5 marks. Mark the given locations on the map using appropriate symbols/signs.
9. No overall choice has been provided in the question paper; however, internal choices are given in some questions. Attempt only one option in such questions.
10. For Visually Impaired students, a separate question has been provided in place of Question No. 14. It is to be attempted only by Visually Impaired students.
11. Maintain neatness and clarity while writing answers.

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) At the current rate of demand, India's coal reserves are estimated to last roughly — **(1)**

(A) 50 more years (B) 15 more years (C) 150 more years (D) 500 more years

(ii) The Bhadla Solar Park, a symbol of India's solar ambitions, is located in the state of — **(1)**

(A) Gujarat (B) Karnataka (C) Rajasthan (D) Tamil Nadu

(iii) Who composed the Telugu epic Amuktamalyada? **(1)**

(A) Harihara (B) Bukka (C) Ramaraya (D) Krishnadevaraya

(iv) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option. **(1)**

1. Rani Durgavati's last battle
2. Battle of Haldighati
3. Second Battle of Panipat
4. Battle of Talikota

(A) 1, 3, 4, 2 (B) 3, 4, 1, 2 (C) 3, 1, 4, 2 (D) 3, 1, 2, 4

(v) Who first compiled the Guru Granth Sahib? **(1)**

(A) Guru Nanak (B) Guru Arjan
(C) Guru Hargobind (D) Guru Gobind Singh

(vi) In which year did the Marathas suffer a disastrous defeat against the Afghans at Panipat? **(1)**

(A) 1761 (B) 1526 (C) 1556 (D) 1771

(vii) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option. **(1)**

Assertion (A): Shivaji's creation of a navy was a revolutionary step for its time.
Reason (R): The Bijapur Sultanate and even the Mughals did not have a full-time naval force.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

(viii) Who wrote 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India' (1901), compiling from British reports the wealth drained out of India? **(1)**

(A) Dadabhai Naoroji (B) Romesh Chunder Dutt
(C) Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay (D) Charles Wilkins

(ix) The Indigo Revolt (1859–62) was directed mainly against — **(1)**

(A) Moneylenders in Chota Nagpur (B) European planters
(C) The Portuguese in Goa (D) Mughal officials

(x) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option. **(1)**

Statement I: Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi captured the fort of Gwalior during the Rebellion of 1857.
Statement II: Nana Saheb led the rebel forces at Lucknow.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

(xi) Before Independence, what share of Indians were eligible to vote? **(1)**

(A) About 5 per cent (B) About 33 per cent
(C) About 13 per cent (D) About 50 per cent

(xii) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option. **(1)**

The ..... century Uttaramerur inscriptions describe a transparent method of selecting representatives, using names drawn from a pot.

(A) 5th (B) 15th (C) 18th (D) 10th

(xiii) The Sengol, a symbol of just rule, is placed in the Parliament building near the — **(1)**

(A) President's seat (B) Entrance gate
(C) Speaker's chair (D) Prime Minister's office

(xiv) The nominal head of the Union Executive in India is the — **(1)**

(A) President (B) Prime Minister (C) Speaker (D) Chief Justice

(xv) In which year did J.R.D. Tata start Tata Airlines, which later became Air India? **(1)**

(A) 1912 (B) 1947 (C) 1992 (D) 1932

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Why is coal called a non-renewable resource? What should be done about its use? **(2)**

OR

2.(B) What is meant by 'human capital'? How is it different from labour? **(2)**

3. Who were Harihara and Bukka? Where, according to folklore, did they build their capital? **(2)**

4.(A) Why did the British call the events of 1857 the 'Sepoy Mutiny'? What do historians call it now? **(2)**

OR

4.(B) Mention any two causes of the Indigo Revolt. **(2)**

5. Mention any two measures of the Election Commission to help persons with disabilities to vote. **(2)**

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe any three achievements of Krishnadevaraya. **(3)**

O R

6.(B) Write any three features of the Hoysala kingdom. **(3)**

7.(A) Explain any three reasons for the decline of Maratha power. **(3)**

O R

7.(B) Describe any three features of the culture of the Thanjavur Marathas under Serfoji II. **(3)**

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Trace the rise of the Sikhs from Guru Nanak to Guru Gobind Singh in five points. **(5)**

O R

8.(B) Explain any five features of the Mughal administration under Akbar. **(5)**

9. Explain the four factors of production and the role of technology, with one example for each. **(5)**

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> Fossil-fuel industrialisation and the clearing of forests have raised the temperature of the Earth. The glaciers of the Himalayas, which feed the great rivers of the plains and are sometimes called the region's 'water tower', now melt faster than snowfall can replace them. If this continues, the rivers that sustain farms and cities may eventually lose their dependable source of water.

Questions:

(10.1) Name any one human activity that has raised the Earth's temperature. (1)

(10.2) What is happening to the glaciers of the Himalayas? (1)

(10.3) How may this affect the people living in the plains? Give two points. (2)

11. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> Krishnadevaraya (16th century) took the Vijayanagara Empire to its peak. A scholar himself, he composed the Telugu epic Amuktamalyada, on the Tamil poet-saint Andal. One section of it, the Rajaniti, sets out his ideas on good governance. He gave generous grants to temples, including those at Tirupati and the Vitthala temple at Vijayanagara, famous for its musical pillars.

Questions:

(11.1) Which Telugu epic did Krishnadevaraya compose? (1)

(11.2) About whom is the epic written? (1)

(11.3) How did Krishnadevaraya support culture and religion? Give two points. (2)

12. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> The Santhals of present-day Jharkhand, Bihar and West Bengal rose in rebellion in 1855–56 under the brothers Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu. Moneylenders and landlords, backed by the British, were taking away their ancestral lands. The Santhals declared their own government and vowed to 'fight to the last drop of blood'. The British burned entire villages and killed thousands, including the rebel leaders.

Questions:

(12.1) Who led the Santhal Rebellion? (1)

(12.2) Against whom did the Santhals rebel? (1)

(12.3) Explain the importance of the Santhal Rebellion in India's resistance to colonial rule. (2)

13. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> Parliament meets in three sessions a year — the Budget, Monsoon and Winter sessions — and usually sits for about six hours each day. Yet its working has been disturbed by absenteeism and disruptions of Question Hour. Productivity of the Rajya Sabha fell from 78 per cent (2004–14) to about 65 per cent after that, and touched a low of 35.75 per cent in 2018.

Questions:

(13.1) Name the three sessions of Parliament held every year. (1)

(13.2) What was the lowest productivity of the Rajya Sabha mentioned, and in which year? (1)

(13.3) Suggest any two ways of improving the functioning of the legislatures. (2)

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: **(5)** (5×1=5)

(I) Belur (Hoysala temples)
(II) Anandpur Sahib
(III) Sindhudurg Fort
(IV) Plassey (Palashi)
(V) Bhadla Solar Park
(VI) Keonjhar iron ore mine

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Belur located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Anandpur Sahib located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Sindhudurg Fort located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Plassey located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Bhadla Solar Park located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Keonjhar iron ore mine located? 1

